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(The Belief In Ar-Rusul (Messengers))

Lecture No. 4

Ar-Rusul is the plural of **Rasool**, which means **Murasal**: The one dispatched to proclaim something. What is intended (according to the Judicial meaning) is that **Ar-Rasool** is the man who receives a **Shar'a** (A Divine code of law) and is commanded by Allaah to convey it. The first of **Ar-Rusul** (The Messenger) is Noah and the last one is Mohammed ﷺ said:

(إنا أوحينا إليك كما أوحينا إلى نوح و النبيين من بعده) (النساء، 136)

Verily, We have inspired you (O Mohammed) as We have inspired to Noah to prophets after him. (Qura'an 4: 136)

In Saheeh Al-Bukharee it is narrated on the authority of Anas bin Malik in the hadeeth of Ash-Shafaa'ah (The Intercession), the prophet Mohammed mentioned that (on the day Resurrection) people will go to Adam asking him to intercede them with Allaah 57

“ Go to Noah , The first of Allaah's Messenger to the people of the earth.

Allaah ﷻ said:

(و ما كان محمدا أبأ أحد من رجالكم و لكن رسول الله و خاتم النبيين) (الأحزاب، 40)

Mohammed is not the father of any man among you, but he is the Messenger of Allaah and the last (end) of His prophets.(Qura'an33:40)

And theree never was a nation without a Messenger whom Allaah ﷻ sends with a particular Sharee'ah to His people or without a prophet receiving the revelation of the Sharee'ah of his predecessor in order to revive it. Allaah ﷻ said:

(و لقد بعثنا في كل أمة رسولا أن أعبدوا الله و اجتنبوا الطاغوت) (النحل، 36)

And verily, We Have sent among every Ummah (community , nation) a Messenger (priclaming): “ Worship Allaah (alone) , and avoid (or keep away from Taaghout.”⁵⁸ (Qura'an 16:36).

He also said:

(و إن من أمة إلا خلا فيها نذير) (فاطر، 24)

There was no Ummaah but a Warner had passed among them (Qura'an 35:24) .

Superiority of Some Messengers over the Others:

Messengers are of various ranks (amongst themselves). Allah says; *"Those Messengers! We preferred some to others..."* [Al-Baqarah 2:253]. The most distinguished Messengers are the five 'Uulul-Azm' (the Strong willed); Prophet Nooh; Prophet Ibraheem, Prophet Moosa; Prophet Esa and; Prophet Muhammad.

Nature of Prophet-hood:

Prophet-hood is an honor from Allah, which He bestows upon whomsoever He pleases, as Allah says; *"Allah chooses Messengers from angels and from men."* [Surah al-Hajj (22): 75]. Prophet-hood is not something which can be acquired by the slave through struggle and exertions, performing different kinds of worships, engaging in tough exercises, persistently disciplining the soul or purification of the heart, refining the manners or spiritually exercising the soul - unlike what the philosophers claim. The philosophers claim that Prophet-hood can be achieved.

The obligation to believe in all the Messengers:

Those who are cited in the Qur'aan by name and those who are not, it is obligatory to specifically believe in the Messengers cited by Allah in the Qur'aan by name. They are twenty-five in all. *As for those Messengers who are not cited in the Qur'aan by name, it is obligatory to believe in them in general.*

Distinction between a Prophet and a Messenger:

The famous distinctions between them are;

- (A Messenger) is a male human being who receives revelation of the Shari'ah and he is ordered to preach it.
- (A Prophet) is a male human who receives revelation of the Shari'ah although he is not ordered to preach it.

Deen of All the Prophets is one:

The Deen of all the Prophets is one, although their Shari'ahs differed. The Prophet said: "The Prophets are paternal brothers; their mothers are different, but their religion is one." [Sahih al-Bukhari].

Characteristics of Prophet-hood of Muhammad PBUH:

Prophet Muhammad possesses exclusive/exceptional merits, which is neither possessed by any other Prophet nor any one from his nation.

1-Prophet Muhammad is the Khaatam an-Nabiyyeen:

(The last/seal of the Prophets) Allah says: "Muhammad is not the father of any man among you, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the last (end) of the Prophets. [Surah al-Ahzab : 40]. The Prophet PBUH said; "I am the last of the Prophets; there is no Prophet after me." [Sunan al-Tirmidhi]

2-Universality of the Prophet-hood of Muhammad:

Allah says; "Say (O Muhammad), "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah." [Surah al-A'raaf : 158]. Prophet Muhammad was sent for the jinn and mankind and his call includes both the jinn and mankind - regardless of their race.

3-Al-Maqaam Al-Mahmood or Shafa'ah Al-kubra:

Al-Maqaam Al-Mahmood - i.e., the great Shafa'ah (al-Shafa'ah aAl-Uzma) as is stated in the Saying of Allah, "It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqaaman Mahmooda (a station of praise and glory)." [Surah al-Israa : 79].

4-The Noble Qur'aan:

The Qur'aan is an eternal miracle which has survived over centuries. Allah has chosen this exquisite miracle for the final divine Prophet-hood (that was sent) for all the people. Allah has challenged man and jinn to produce anything like it, or ten verses like it or (even) a (short) Surah (i.e., only three verses) like it. But no one has produced anything like it - since the advent of Prophet Muhammad until today. And no one will - until eternity - be able to produce a book like the Qur'aan, or even a Surah like it.

5-Ascension to the highest Heaven:

Hafidh ibn Katheer (rahimahullah) writes in his Tafseer; "The truth is that the Prophet was taken (on the journey) when he was awake, and not in a dream. He traveled from Makkah to Bayt al-Muqaddis riding on al-Buraaq (the beast). Upon reaching the door of the mosque, he tied the beast by the door and entered it. He prayed two units of prayer as, 'Tahyatul-Masjid.'

Then al-Me'raaj was brought to him. So he ascended to the first heaven, and then to the rest of the seven heavens. He greeted the Prophets who were on the various heavens according to their positions and ranks. The Prophet saw Sidrat al-Muntaha

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(the Lote-Tree), which was covered - by the command of Allah - with butterflies of gold and various colors. It was surrounded by the angels. There the Prophet saw Angel Jibra'eel in his real form, with six hundred wings. He saw green cushions covering the horizon. The Prophet saw al-Bayt al-Ma'moor (the Much-Frequented House) and Ibrahim al-Khalil.

Finality of Prophet-hood

The unanimous Belief of Muslim world is that Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) is the Last and Final Messenger/Prophet of Allah. In other words Prophet-hood has ended with Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) and those who do not believe in it are ventured out of the bounds of Islam.

1-Proof from Quran:

Quran states: Muhammad is not the father of any of your men, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the Last of the prophets; and Allah is cognizant of all things. (Qur'an:33:40)

2-Proof from Hadith:

Anas bin Malik narrates from the Prophet (Peace be upon him) who said: The Messenger-ship and Prophet-hood have ended and there will be no Messenger and Prophet after me. [Sunnan al-Tirmidhi, Hadith # 2274] Abu Huraira reported Allah's Messenger (may peace be upon him) as saying: The Last Hour would not come “UNTIL THERE WOULD ARISE ABOUT THIRTY IMPOSTERS, LIARS, AND EACH ONE OF THEM WOULD CLAIM THAT HE IS A MESSENGER OF ALLAH” [Sahih Muslim:6988]

3-The Constitution Law of Pakistan:

298-C: Any person of the Qadiani group or the Lahori group (who call themselves Ahmadis or any other name), who directly or indirectly, possess himself as a Muslim, or calls, or refers to, his faith as Islam, or preaches or propagates his faith, or invites others to accept his faith, by words, either spoken or written, or by visible representation or in any manner whatsoever outrages the religious feelings of Muslims, shall be punished with imprisonment of either description for a term which may extend to three years and shall also be liable to fine.